

RICHARD OSUNGU

Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (MEAL) | Research Professional

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven MEAL and Research professional with over 7 years of progressive experience across humanitarian, public health, livelihoods, and community development programs in Kenya. Currently serving as a MEAL Manager, providing strategic leadership in the design, implementation, and continuous strengthening of robust MEAL systems for complex, multi-donor portfolios, including Global Fund-supported malaria interventions, mental health, disability inclusion, and basic needs programming.

Highly proficient in mixed-methods research design and execution, combining rigorous qualitative approaches (KIIs, FGDs, thematic analysis, codebook development) with advanced quantitative and routine data analysis across KHIS, surveys, and administrative datasets. Technical toolkit spans Advanced Excel, SPSS, Python, Data Studio, and Power BI. Demonstrated expertise in implementation research and digital health evaluations, contributing directly to evidence generation, adaptive management, and informed scale-up decisions.

Widely recognized for institutionalizing data quality standards, accountability frameworks, and organizational learning cultures; mentoring MEAL teams; driving meaningful stakeholder engagement; and translating complex datasets into clear, actionable insights that drive strategic and operational decision-making across diverse program contexts.

CORE COMPETENCIES

MEAL Systems Strengthening and Framework Design | Theory of Change (ToC) and Logframe Development | Indicator Performance Tracking Tables (IPTT) | Data Quality Assessments (DQAs) | Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP) | Mixed-Methods Research and Program Evaluation | Quantitative and Qualitative Data Analysis | Digital Data Systems (ODK, Kobo, KHIS, eCHIS) | Data Visualization (Power BI, Excel, Looker Studio) | Capacity Building and Training | Donor Reporting and Compliance

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Data Analysis: Advanced Excel, SPSS, Python, R, SQL
- Data Visualization: Power BI, Looker Studio, Matplotlib
- Digital Data Collection: Kobo Toolbox, ODK, ONA
- Spatial Analysis: QGIS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TINADA Youth Action Africa - MEAL Manager

April 2025 - Present

- Designed and operationalized a comprehensive MEAL system for malaria control interventions in Kakamega and Kisii Counties, covering 528 CHUs, ensuring full alignment with donor frameworks and national health reporting standards.
- Led the design and oversight of MEAL systems to monitor progress against logframe indicators for the Bridge Beyond Barriers (B3) and Basic Needs Projects, integrating disability inclusion and mental health components.
- Supervised, coached, and mentored 3 MEAL Officers, 25 coaches, and 20 peer educators in operationalizing data collection tools, implementing quality assurance protocols, and producing accurate, disaggregated datasets across mental health projects.
- Strengthened community accountability mechanisms (AAP), enhancing feedback and program responsiveness.

Secours Islamique France (SIF) - MEAL Officer

January 2025 - December 2025

- Conducted in-depth qualitative data analysis on community perceptions of humanitarian interventions using thematic coding to generate actionable insights for program adaptation.
- Performed descriptive and comparative statistical analyses on baseline, endline, and post-distribution monitoring (PDM) datasets to measure progress against targets and evaluate program effectiveness.
- Supported mixed-methods research activities, including rapid needs assessments, baseline and endline surveys, and the design of structured interview guides and FGD discussion themes.
- Proactively documented and disseminated 5 lessons learned and best practices to internal and external stakeholders, strengthening organizational learning and supporting continuous program improvement.

Practical Action Kenya – Temporary MEL Assistant

July 2024 - October 2024

- Conducted qualitative field assessments to evaluate youth engagement within the Resilient Agriculture project, generating evidence to inform adaptive programming.
- Performed quantitative trend analysis on project performance indicators, enhancing real-time monitoring capacity and improving the timeliness of program decision-making.
- Designed and facilitated 15 capacity-building sessions for field teams on MEL best practices, data collection standards, and donor reporting compliance requirements.
- Oversaw deployment and quality management of digital data collection tools (ONA, Kobo Toolbox) to improve data accuracy, completeness, and operational efficiency.
- Led documentation of lessons learned, contributing to organizational knowledge management systems and evidence-based adaptive programming.

Belfast Millers Limited - Market Research Analyst

March 2023 - April 2024

- Conducted in-depth market research on animal feed industry trends, competitor landscapes, and customer preferences, producing data-driven recommendations that enhanced product positioning and market penetration strategies.
- Designed and executed qualitative customer feedback analyses, including farmer testimonials on feed quality and livestock performance, to inform product development decisions.
- Authored 10 comprehensive research reports integrating qualitative and quantitative insights to support evidence-based marketing and product strategy.
- Developed interactive Power BI dashboards to synthesize qualitative insights alongside sales data, improving real-time monitoring and strategic decision-making at senior management level.

State Department for Fisheries, Aquaculture and the Blue Economy (ABDP) - MEAL Officer *November 2020 - December 2022*

- Developed and managed M and E frameworks to support evidence-based decision-making in aquaculture development projects, achieving a 25% improvement in data-driven insights for government and donor stakeholders.
- Conducted quarterly data quality audits (DQAs), reducing data discrepancies by 30% and ensuring the integrity of baseline, mid-term, and end-term evaluation data.
- Led cross-functional data governance activities to align program outcomes with key performance indicators (KPIs) and national government reporting standards.
- Conducted qualitative evaluations to assess smallholder farmers' experiences, technology adoption, and challenges within the aquaculture value chain, informing targeted program adjustments.
- Produced 3 case studies and success stories documenting farmer experiences with new technologies, facilitating continuous knowledge sharing among stakeholders and program partners.

Women Fighting AIDS in Kenya (WOFAK) - Monitoring and Evaluation Assistant (Case Manager) *September 2017 - September 2020*

- Conducted qualitative interviews with caregivers, children, and key stakeholders to assess the effectiveness of HIV/AIDS intervention programs and identify gaps in service delivery.
- Led qualitative analysis of case management reports to generate evidence-based recommendations that directly improved service delivery outcomes for vulnerable children.
- Facilitated M and E training and capacity-building sessions for 10 program officers, enhancing field data collection skills, monitoring methodologies, and accountability practices.
- Integrated the Child Protection Information Management System (CPIMS) for real-time tracking of vulnerable children, strengthening program accountability and informed case management.

- Documented best practices and key learning outcomes for donor reporting and future programming improvements, contributing to institutional knowledge management.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Data Science - University of East London

2026 - Present (Ongoing)

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Computer Science - Meru University of Science and Technology (2019)

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

- Project Management Essentials - DisasterReady.org (2026)
- Data Science for Monitoring and Evaluation - Humanitarian Data Science Academy (2024)
- Artificial Intelligence Essentials - ALX Africa (2024)
- Certificate in Monitoring and Evaluation - Mount Kenya University (2020)
- Fundraising and Mobilization of Resources - Kenya Community Development Fund (2019)

RESEARCH, PROJECTS AND PUBLICATIONS

Implementation Research - Malaria and Digital Health Evaluation | Medic Afya | TINADA Youth Action Africa | 2025 - 2026

Strengthening Febrile Illness Management in Kenya: A Malaria-Focused Evaluation of the HealthPulse AI and eCHIS Integration on Diagnostic Accuracy, Health Worker Adoption, and Cost-Effectiveness.

- Led the MEL and research coordination for an 11-month implementation research study evaluating the integration of the HealthPulse AI digital mRDT reader into eCHIS to improve febrile illness diagnosis and malaria surveillance in Kakamega and Kisii Counties.
- Generated evidence on mRDT diagnostic accuracy, CHP adoption of digital tools, malaria treatment decision-making, and service delivery performance - contributing to national policy discussions on digital health scale-up.

Aquaculture Value Chain Study and Blue Book Development | Government of Kenya & IFAD | Department for Fisheries,

Aquaculture and the Blue Economy | January - June 2021

- Collaborated with the Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock, Fisheries and Cooperatives to design and execute a national study to identify and document key stakeholders and value chain players in Kenya's aquaculture sector.
- Findings informed national aquaculture strategy and improved data accessibility, culminating in a comprehensive Blue Book adopted by policymakers for programme planning and resource allocation.
- Analyzed industry data to provide actionable insights on aquaculture value chains, supporting programme scalability, government initiatives, and sustainable aquaculture growth in Kenya.

Mobilization of Walking Aids for Persons with Disabilities | Kisumu County | 2016

- Spearheaded a walking aid mobilization initiative benefiting 300+ persons with disabilities (PWDs) in Kisumu County, partnering with local healthcare providers, NGOs, and community leaders to assess mobility needs and distribute customized aids.
- Improved beneficiaries' mobility, access to education and employment opportunities, and social integration; raised community awareness of PWD rights and inspired community-led inclusive infrastructure actions.

VOLUNTEERING AND LEADERSHIP

- Chairperson, Nyakach University Students Association - Mobilized resources and led community development initiatives on behalf of the student body.
- Led a Tree Planting Initiative in Nyakach Constituency to promote environmental conservation and community resilience.
- Organized a Youth Sports Tournament in Nyakach (football, basketball, volleyball) to identify, promote, and nurture youth talent in the community.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.